

Tornado Damage Reanalysis



Dvorce Tornado - 19 April 2026

CENTRAL EUROPEAN STORM FORECASTS

Dvorce / Jičín Tornado - 19 April 2026

Event: Dvorce tornado

Date/time: 19 April 2026, approximately 17:20

Location: Dvorce near Jičín, Czechia

Estimated path length: approximately 1.3 km

Estimated maximum width: approximately 20 m

Estimated movement direction: W-NE

Survey type: Post-event amateur field reanalysis

Official rating: IF0.5

Preliminary rating: IF1

Estimated central wind speed: approximately 40 m/s / 150 km/h

Possible IF range: IF0.5-IF1

Confidence: Medium

Summary

The Dvorce tornado was originally assessed as **IF0.5**, but this rating appears to have been based on limited or non-detailed surveying. A later field visit and reanalysis found a narrow, continuous damage corridor approximately **1.3 km long** and around **20 m wide**.

The strongest reliable damage evidence was tree damage, especially **TR3-level damage**, including an uprooted large tree or major root failure. Additional supporting evidence included scattered tree-stand damage, multiple damaged trees, large broken branches, and branches or light debris reportedly thrown up to approximately **100 m**.

Based on the available evidence, the most reasonable rating is **IF1**, with a possible range from **IF0.5 to IF1**.

Damage Evidence

The main damage indicators documented during the reanalysis were related to trees and vegetation.

The strongest reliable damage indicator was:

TR3 – Trees, DoD 3:

Uprooted tree or major root failure, depending on tree health, root strength, and soil conditions.

Supporting indicators included:

TS2 – Tree stands, DoD 2:

Scattered or significant tree damage within a tree stand.

TR2 – Trees, DoD 2:

Large branches or parts of tree crowns broken.

Several trees were damaged along the path. Large branches were reportedly thrown around **100 m**, which supports the presence of a localized tornadic wind field and debris transport. However, thrown branches alone were not used as the primary basis for the rating, because branch weight, shape, and exposure can strongly affect transport distance.

Important Field Finding

One tree that initially appeared to be a strong snapped-tree case was later found to be less reliable as high-end evidence. Field inspection showed that it was not a normal single healthy trunk, but rather two trees or stems connected only near the bottom. Because of this structure, the smaller tree/stem would have been mechanically weaker and easier to snap or fall.

For this reason, this damage was **not treated as strong TR4 evidence** and was not used to justify an IF1.5 rating. Instead, it was considered supporting evidence only.

Uncertainty

There are several important uncertainties that prevent a higher rating:

- The health and structural condition of the damaged trees is not fully known.
- The large uprooted tree may have been affected by wet soil, as there had been significant rain before the event.
- No significant building damage was documented.
- The snapped-tree case was found to involve a weaker double-stem or connected-tree structure.
- Tree damage can be strongly affected by exposure, rooting depth, soil moisture, disease, and pre-existing weakness.

Because of these uncertainties, the tornado should not be rated above **IF1** without stronger evidence from healthy trees or structural damage.

Interpretation

The damage pattern supports a weak tornado, especially because the damage was found in a narrow corridor with a mapped start and end point, a peak damage area, multiple compared damage indicators, and

supporting photo/video/witness/radar evidence. Straight-line wind was considered as an alternative, but the available footage, narrow and localized nature of the damage supports a tornadic interpretation.

The original **IF0.5** rating may be understandable if based only on limited evidence, but the later field reanalysis suggests that the tornado likely reached **IF1 intensity** at peak damage.

Final Preliminary Conclusion

The Dvorce tornado of 19 April 2026 is best preliminarily assessed as **IF1**, mainly based on **TR3 tree damage**, including uprooting or major root failure, supported by scattered tree-stand damage and large broken/thrown branches.

A higher rating such as **IF1.5** is not currently supported, because the strongest possible snapped-tree evidence was weakened by the discovery that the tree was a connected/double-stem structure, and because soil moisture and tree health remain uncertain.

Final rating: IF1

Possible range: IF0.5-IF1

Confidence: Medium to medium-low

Main evidence: TR3 tree damage, TS2 tree-stand damage, TR2 branch/crown damage

